

Cognitive Functions

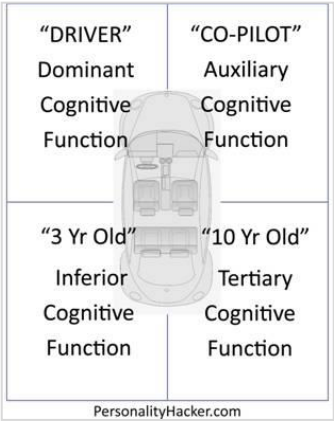
Cognitive functions are the technical term for “Modes of processing information and making decisions based on your Myers-Briggs type.” Each type has four (out of a possible eight) cognitive functions, which they use in a specific order. Identifying which functions you use – and in what order – is the most accurate way to type yourself or anyone else.

ESFJ Functions ESFJ Primary Processes

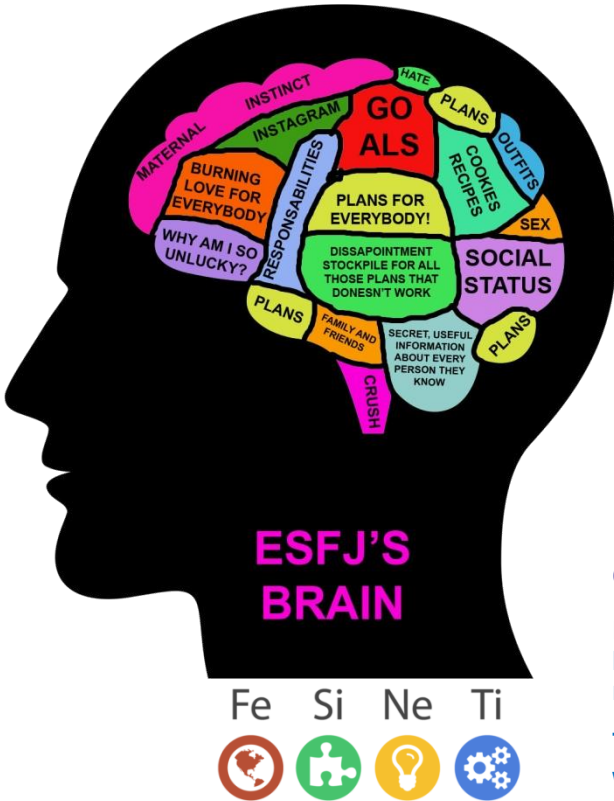
Role	Process	Snapshot
Leading “Driver”	Extroverted Feeling	Connecting and considering others and the group
Supportive “Co-Pilot”	Introverted Sensing	Reviewing and recalling past experiences and seeking detailed data
Relief “10 year old”	Extroverted iNtuition	Interpreting situations and relationships and pickup meanings and interconnections to other contexts
Aspirational “3 year old”	Introverted Thinking	Analysing, categorising, and evaluating according to principles

The analogy of a car is a useful model when thinking about cognitive functions. The first function is the 'driver' of the personality type and is the function from which perspective of all of the other functions follow. It provides the direction and speed. The second function is the 'co-pilot', which navigates around or through any difficulties encountered. The inferior, or 3 year old, function attempts to distract both primary and secondary functions whereas the tertiary function, or '10 year old', only distracts the current dominant function.

Understanding cognitive functions is imperative to understanding type. The four-letter dichotomies cannot possibly explain the complexity of our personalities – we are all thinkers, feelers, sensors and intuitives in various situations. The cognitive functions allow us to understand when we use each function and how it impacts our decision-making process.



The Cognitive Functions



Role	Process	Snapshot
Ne	Extroverted Intuition	How do concepts happen outside me?
Ni	Introverted Intuition	How do concepts happen within me?
Fe	Extroverted Feeling	How does this make others feel?
Fi	Introverted Feeling	Experiencing and acting in the immediate context.
Te	Extroverted Thinking	How does this logically affect things?
Ti	Introverted Thinking	How does this logically affect me?
Se	Extroverted Sensing	How is the environment outside me?
Si	Introverted Sensing	How is the environment inside me?

CONCLUSION

ESFJ Supporters are nurturing and responsible. They go to great lengths to meet the physical needs of others. They are willing to make enormous sacrifices on behalf of their loved ones.

Their greatest contribution is their genuine concern for others, which drives everything they do.

What is MBTI?

Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI) is a tool that helps people gain insights about themselves and how they interact with others—and improve how they communicate, learn, and work.

Often referred to as a 'personality test', MBTI actually has less to do with one's personality and everything to do with how their brain works from receiving and processing external information to communication preferences. These preferences are split into four pairs – I/E, S/N, F/T and J/P. Though everyone is unique and will have some traits of all 8 letters, people will often be more inclined towards one letter in each pair. By determining your preference in each group, and putting these four letters together, you get your personality type code – for you, this is ESFJ.

ESFJ – The Facilitator

What does that mean?

- Extroverted Energised by time with others
- Sensing Pays attention to facts and details
- Feeling Prioritises people and emotions
- Judging Prefers structure and order

People who share the ESFJ personality type are, for lack of a better word, popular. In high school, ESFJs are the cheerleaders and the quarterbacks, setting the tone, taking the spotlight and leading their teams forward to victory and fame. Later in life, ESFJs continue to enjoy supporting their friends and loved ones, organising social gatherings and doing their best to make sure everyone is happy.

ESFJs are conscientious helpers, sensitive to the needs of others and energetically dedicated to their responsibilities. They are highly attuned to their emotional environment and attentive to both the feelings of others and the perception others have of them.

ESFJs like a sense of harmony and cooperation around them, and are eager to please and provide. ESFJs value loyalty and tradition, and usually make their family and friends their top priority.



They are generous with their time, effort, and emotions. They often take on the concerns of others as if they were their own, and will attempt to put their significant organisational talents to use to bring order to other people's lives.

ESFJs act according to a strict moral code, and look for others to do the same. They often see things in terms of black and white, right and wrong, and they are typically not shy about sharing their evaluations of others' behaviour. ESFJs seek harmony and cooperation, and feel this is best accomplished when everyone follows the same set of rules. They have a sense of order in the way people relate to one another, and often take on roles that allow them to help enforce that social order.

Strengths

- Strong Practical Skills** – ESFJs are excellent managers of day-to-day tasks and routine maintenance, enjoying making sure that those who are close to them are well cared for.
- Strong Sense of Duty** – ESFJs have a strong sense of responsibility and strive to meet their obligations, though this may sometimes be more from a sense of social expectations than intrinsic drive.
- Very Loyal** – Valuing stability and security very highly, ESFJs are eager to preserve the status quo, which makes them extremely loyal and trustworthy partners and employees.
- Sensitive and Warm** – Helping to ensure that stability, ESFJs seek harmony and care deeply about other people's feelings, and are strong team players.
- Good at Connecting with Others** – ESFJs are social, comfortable and well-liked. They have a strong need to "belong", and have no problem with small talk or following social cues in order to help them take an active role in their communities.

Weaknesses

- Worried about Their Social Status** – ESFJs' have a preoccupation with social status and influence, which affects many decisions they make, potentially limiting their creativity and open-mindedness.
- Inflexible** – ESFJs place a lot of importance on what is socially acceptable, and can be very cautious, even critical of anything unconventional or outside the mainstream.
- Reluctant to Innovate or Improve** – Just as they can be critical of others' "unusual" behaviour, ESFJs may also be unwilling to step out of their own comfort zones, usually for fear of being (or just appearing) different.
- Vulnerable to Criticism** – ESFJs are conflict-averse. They can become very defensive and hurt if someone, especially a person close to them, criticises their habits, beliefs or traditions.
- Often Too Needy** – ESFJs need to hear and see a great deal of appreciation.
- Too Selfless** – ESFJs sometimes try to establish their value with doting attention, something that can quickly overwhelm those who don't need it, making it ultimately unwelcome. Furthermore, ESFJs often neglect their own needs in the process.



Recognising the ESFJ

ESFJs may often be found playing host or hostess. They tend to take on the role of organiser without hesitation, and want to be sure that everyone is taken care of. Roles such as committee leader, event planner, and church volunteer suit the ESFJ well. They are typically engaged with their communities and work hard to do their part in maintaining the social order. ESFJs are interested in other people and like to know the details of their lives. Gossip is a favourite pastime of many ESFJs; they love to share stories about the people around them.

ESFJs have a clear moral code that guides their behaviour and their expectations from others. They often have strong opinions about how people should behave and the proper thing to do. Manners and other codes of social interaction are often of great interest to ESFJs. They may think in terms of black and white, right and wrong. They can be judgmental of others who they do not think are acting appropriately, but they have the best of intentions: they simply want everyone to follow the rules so they can all get along. The ESFJ wants things to be all right with the people around them, and may become very involved with others' problems and concerns.



Career

ESFJs are hardworking and responsible people. They take comfort in routine. At work they like to create a warm and friendly environment. They are willing to make sacrifices to benefit others. ESFJs seek jobs that provide interaction and are altruistic in nature.

As subordinates: With clearly defined responsibilities and a sense of purpose, ESFJs are patient, efficient, hard-working people who respect the authority of their managers. While ESFJs may struggle with too much freedom and improvisation, they thrive in workplaces with structure, safety and guidelines. Routine tasks are not a problem for ESFJs, and their dedication and loyalty earn them the respect of their managers.

As colleagues: Teamwork is a concept that ESFJs have no trouble putting into practice. Often seeking friends at work, people with this personality type are almost always willing to lend a hand when and where it's needed. Excellent networkers, ESFJs always seem to "know just the guy" to bring a project together on time. On the other hand, ESFJs often need to work on a team – being stuck alone chipping away at paperwork for days on end just leaves them tired and unfulfilled.

As managers: ESFJs enjoy the responsibility that comes with organising social situations, and the enjoyment they feel in managing other people translates well into management positions. As team leaders, ESFJs find ways to make everyone feel involved, uniting people and smoothing relations in order to get things done.

Career Matches

- Accountant
- Bookkeeper
- Child Care
- Human Resources
- Counsellor
- Family Doctor
- Homemaker
- Nurse
- Teacher
- Social Worker
- Office Manager
- Administrator
- Speech Pathologist
- Organisation Leader
- Receptionist
- Administrative Assistant

Popular ESFJ hobbies

- Volunteering in community charity, or religious organisations
- Celebrating holidays and family traditions
- Cooking
- Entertaining
- Social sports



Relationships

ESFJs focus on their family and close friends. They love people and are gifted at bringing people together. They share themselves freely and generously. ESFJs are very adept at reading others people's feelings. They are often popular, likeable and seek lasting relationships.

Social types, ESFJs seek large circles of friends are more than willing to spend the time and energy necessary to maintain these relationships. Loyal and warm, they are known for standing by their friends no matter what..

Prizing social validation and a sense of belonging so highly, romantic relationships hold a special level of importance for ESFJs. No other kind of relationship provides ESFJs with the same level of support and devotion, and the feelings of security and stability that come with strong romantic relationships are extremely warming.

Kindred spirits:

ISFJ, ESTJ, ESFP

Intriguing differences:

ISTJ, ISFP, ESTP, ENFP

INTP, INTJ, INFP and ENTJ personalities can clash and conflict with the ESFJ, but may also offer the best opportunities for growth. With fundamentally different values and motivations, their strengths are the ESFJ's weaknesses, and if they are able to develop a relationship, they can learn a tremendous amount from each other.



Burnout

ESFJs will become burnt out and overwhelmed if:

- they feel like they aren't capable of getting things done fast enough.

ESTJs will go a rather long time without stopping to take breaks, and because of this they often suffer from burn out. ESTJs are hardworking, and often take on many different tasks.

An ESTJ who is suffering from burn out, won't be as focused and driven as they usually are. They might find themselves completely stagnant and in incapable of moving forward. This is very difficult for ESTJ, especially as they watch their tasks piling up around them. The ESTJ might need to ask for help when this occurs, which is actually very difficult for them to do. If their loved ones can find the time to take care of some of the things the ESTJ needs to get done, it will really help them relax and get back to themselves.



ESFJ Stressors



Change

The main goal of the ESFJ is to make sure that their loved ones are happy. When change is presented to their lives they often become uneasy and anxious. They work very hard to create a sense of harmony in their environment, and often struggle when this is disrupted. They respond to the people around them, making them capable of welcoming small changes if the people they care about desire this. They will find ways of coping, but will still be uneasy with these changes. The ESFJ enjoys keeping their lives organised and concise. They want to know what is to come, disliking too many unknown variables. They attempt to balance the needs of everyone around them, which can be a very delicate task.

Famous ESFJs

- William McKinley, American President
- Don Knotts, Comedian
- Sally Field, Actress
- Nancy Kerrigan, Olympic Figure Skater
- Desi Arnaz, Actor, Comedian, Musician
- Mary Tyler Moore, Actress, Comedian
- Reba McEntire, Singer
- Danny Glover, Actor

Fictional ESFJs

- Hoss Cartwright, Bonanza
- Leonard "Bones" McCoy, Star Trek
- Monica Gellar, Friends
- Dorothy, The Wizard of Oz
- Donald Duck, Disney Cartoon Character
- Rabbit, Winnie the Pooh

Your character matches:

Game of Thrones:



Cersei Lannister

Disney:



Hercules

What makes ESFJs happy?

- Fully making their loved ones happy.
- Feeling truly appreciated and wanted.
- When people confide in them, and express that they trust them.
- Being told they did something well, and that others are impressed with them.
- Cooking a delicious meal for others.
- Taking the pressure off of their loved ones.
- Making others happy.
- Being loved unconditionally.
- Smiling.
- Love.
- Compassion.

